KENNETH GOES TO BRNO

SHADOW IT 2.0
Jonas Hermansson · IT-HUSET



Who is Kenneth?

A fictional colleague in procurement.

He began as a humorous LinkedIn post.
Then became #VeckansKenneth.

You can connect with him on LinkedIn.
Yes, Kenneth has a profile too.



“I’ll just automate one little thing.”

Kenneth got access to Claude Code…



Meet Kenneth.
Good intentions. A real problem.
A very powerful new toolkit.

Before lunch

One app. One workflow. One agent.
Two integrations. 43 users.

IT has no idea.



Shadow IT got a turbo

THEN
A spreadsheet in a mysterious folder.

NOW
Software that reads, decides and acts.

Kenneth has a point

The queue is long.
The task is repetitive.
The problem is real.

He found a way forward.



Monday, 09:07

“We can’t process orders.”

Kenneth is on holiday.



Congratulations.
You have users.

Bug reports.
Feature requests.
Support tickets.

Your little tool has a second job.



What changed?

People now depend on it.
Data crosses system boundaries.
An agent can take actions.

Responsibility grew with the app.

We’re glad we have all these Kenneths

They see problems, take initiative and build useful things.

And suddenly we also have…

Software IT does not know exists.
Unmaintained apps with no updates or support.
Unknown integrations and hidden dependencies.
Sensitive data shared with external services.
Security holes and excessive permissions.
Business-critical workflows with no clear owner.

Kenneth built the solution. Who owns everything that comes with it?

“It’s just a spreadsheet.”

Kenneth pastes supplier data into a prompt.
Prices. Personal details. Contract terms.

Sensitive content can end up in
chat history, logs or shared answers.

The task was small. The exposure wasn’t.



“The free tool was really good.”

Kenneth uploads a contract to an external service.
Then connects a plugin to the supplier folder.

Who receives the data? Who else can access it?
How long is it stored? Can it be deleted?

An approved AI tool does not approve every connection.

“I’ll add security later.”

The app works. But the API lacks access checks.
A secret key sits in the browser code.
An AI response becomes executable content.

Possible result:
Exposed records, stolen credentials
or actions the user never authorised.



“Admin access fixed it.”

Kenneth gives the agent access to the whole drive.
It can also change records and send emails.

One mistaken or manipulated instruction can now
expose documents or alter business data.

The permissions define how much damage is possible.

“It was only a supplier PDF.”

Kenneth’s agent reads an external document.
Hidden instructions try to redirect its task.

With broad access and outbound tools,
it could send internal data elsewhere.

External content must stay untrusted.



When an agent can act

Reading a purchase order is one thing.
Changing it is another.

A larger action space needs
tighter permissions and review.



Kenneths Three levels of Apps

PERSONAL TOOL

SHARED APPLICATION

BUSINESS WORKFLOW

The internal app store

A catalogue connected to the pipeline.

Agents draft descriptions and data inventories.
The pipeline records checks and versions.
Owners approve use and handle exceptions.

Five questions before production

01 Who owns it?
02 What data does it use?
03 Who uses it?
04 How do we monitor and version it?
05 How do we stop it?

Agents collect evidence. People own the answers.

How do we handles this? Automated data checks!

Agents help map data flows.
Automated checks flag security and access issues.
Policies restrict destinations and retention.

People decide which data use is acceptable.

The OFF button

Automatic stops at defined limits.
Scripted access revocation.
Logs for agent-assisted diagnosis.
Tested recovery procedures.

A human can always intervene.



Governance as fire protection

Nobody applauds the fire exit.

Until they need it.



Rules inside the tools (Claude Code in our case)

Guidance explains the rules.
Permissions limit the actions.
Hooks can check tool calls.
Managed settings apply central controls.

Automation and accountability

Kenneth contributes domain knowledge.
AI agents build, test and investigate.
Pipelines enforce checks and record evidence.
IT owns the platform and access controls.
People set direction and accept business risk.

More Kenneths.
Clear responsibility.

Keep the curiosity.
Give good ideas a route to production.



Let’s connect on LinkedIn

Kenneth would like to be your LinkedIn friend. So would I.

Kenneth från inköp

Jonas Hermansson

Questions and conversation

jonas.hermansson@it-huset.se